

PORTFOLIO STRATEGY BRIEF

Which niche actually converts into revenue?

Content Creation leads all sizeable niches in startup success rate, edging out Marketing and Education — a data read of 1,000 indie & bootstrapped startups.

Source: TrustMRR 1,000-row dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026

How we defined “success”

01

The dataset

1,000 startups listed on TrustMRR, a marketplace for indie & bootstrapped SaaS/apps, each with self-reported live revenue metrics.

02

The filter

726 startups have a labeled niche (“category”). We kept niches with at least 15 startups so the rate isn't driven by 2-3 outliers.

03

The success bar

A startup counts as a success once it clears \$1,000 in monthly recurring revenue (MRR) — the standard marker of early product-market fit.

04

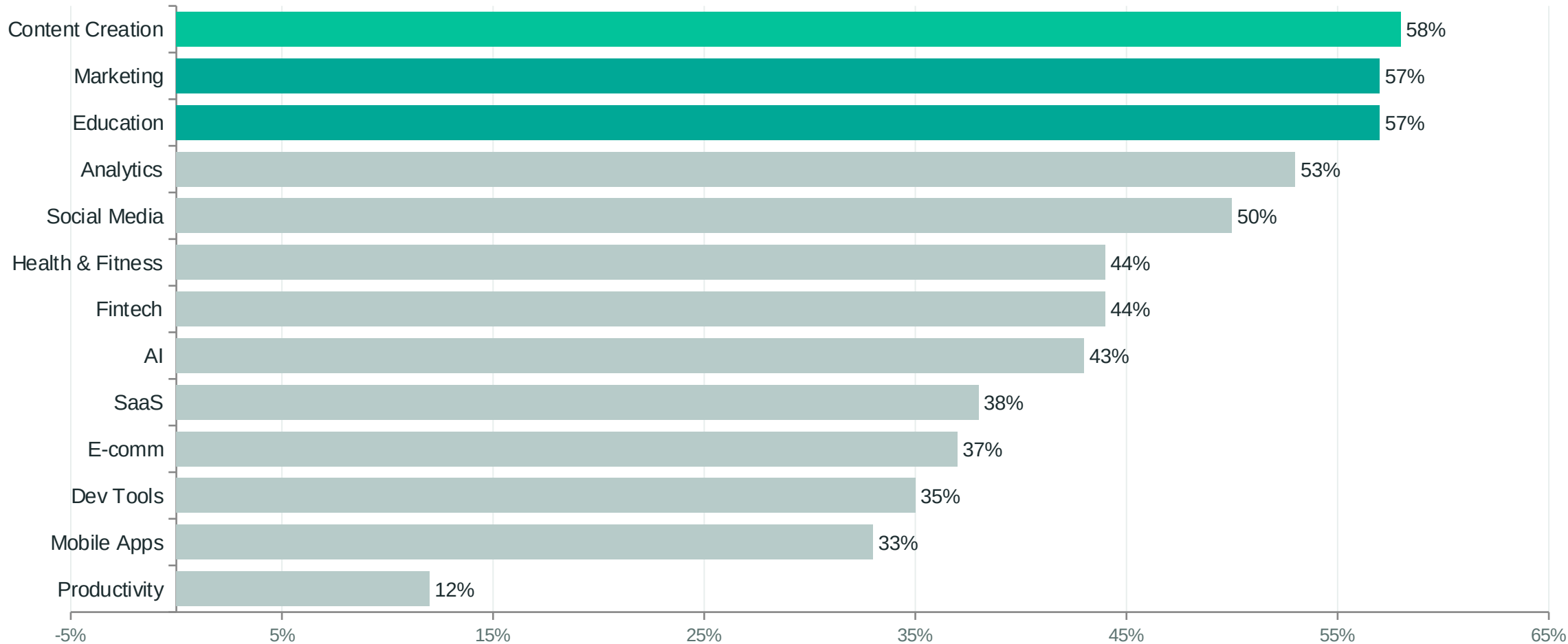
The metric

Success rate = share of startups in a niche that have reached that \$1,000 MRR bar, at the moment this snapshot was taken.

THE FINDING

Content Creation has the highest startup success rate

Share of startups per niche that reached \$1,000+ MRR (niches with 15+ startups in sample)



Inside the Content Creation niche

58%

reach \$1,000+ MRR

36

startups in sample

\$1,254

median MRR

31%

currently listed for sale

Top-earning startups in the niche (by MRR)

Startup	Audience	MRR	12-mo revenue
Produce.so	B2C	\$27,371	\$26,981
Marky	B2B	\$22,733	\$297,728
StoryShort	B2C	\$22,363	\$327,105
Draft AI	B2C	\$17,425	\$193,431
AutoContent API	B2B	\$17,036	\$169,160

Why this niche is converting

Low delivery cost: AI writing, video and repurposing tools scale to thousands of users without added headcount. **Clear willingness to pay:** creators and brands already budget for content tools, shortening the sales cycle. **Exit-ready:** 31% on-sale rate shows a healthy, liquid market of buyers for niche assets.

A tight race at the top

Content Creation, Marketing, and Education post nearly identical success rates — but win for different reasons.

Content Creation

58%

success rate

36 startups

\$1,254 median MRR

Highest raw hit-rate. Smallest sample of the three — watch for regression as more startups list.

Marketing

57%

success rate

42 startups

\$1,586 median MRR

Largest sample of the leaders, and the highest median MRR — the most statistically solid #1 candidate.

Education

57%

success rate

30 startups

\$2,142 median MRR

Highest median MRR of any leading niche — fewer winners, but the ones that land go deeper.

Three caveats on the data

1

Self-selected listing, not a market census

TrustMRR only includes founders who chose to list — often to sell. It skews toward small, bootstrapped products, not VC-backed or stealth companies, and likely undercounts failures that never got listed.

2

One snapshot in time

This is a frozen cut from 30 Jul 2026. “Success” at \$1,000 MRR says nothing about retention, churn, or whether that revenue survives 12 months out.

3

Category sample sizes vary widely

Content Creation's lead rests on 36 startups vs. 197 for AI. The ranking is directional, not a statistically airtight verdict — treat the top 3 as a cluster, not a single winner.

RECOMMENDATION

Prioritize sourcing in Content Creation, Marketing, and Education

- Treat Content Creation, Marketing, and Education as one leading cluster (57-58% hit \$1,000+ MRR) — all three clear a materially higher bar than AI (43%) or SaaS (38%) broadly.
- Use Education and Marketing's larger samples and higher median MRR to de-risk sourcing while Content Creation's ceiling plays out.
- Before committing capital, validate with a second, non-listing-biased dataset — this read is a strong prior, not a standalone thesis.